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Quantification of security events using behavioral, analytical, and threat intelligence attributes

Abstract

A system for testing a security object is disclosed. The system comprises processors and memory storing a plurality of security engines and instructions that, when executed by the processors, causes the system to: access a decision tree comprising a first node and a plurality of second nodes; link a first leaf node of the decision tree with a first security engine; link a second leaf node of the decision tree with a second security engine; receive a security object comprising a digital asset that is attackable using one or more attack execution operations; and test the security object using the decision tree to determine a security threat parameter for the security object. The security threat parameter may be used to prioritize one or more remediation steps for mitigating against the one or more attack execution operations associated with the digital asset.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims priority to and is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/564,293, filed Dec. 29, 2021, the disclosure of which is incorporated by reference in its entirety for all purposes.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to methods and systems for testing security objects using a decision tree. More specifically, the present disclosure describes testing one or more security objects using a decision tree to determine a security threat parameter that is used to remediate against computer security attacks.

BACKGROUND

(2) A major challenge in the computer security industry is a lack of reliable computer security tools that leverage information from multiple and disparate sources to mitigate against computer security attacks. Such tools, for example, may: analyze and more efficiently test security objects (e.g., from

files, URLs, file paths, file hashes, etc.); assign security parameters that characterize or otherwise quantify risk or vulnerability to security objects, generate attack trends or attack kill-chains associated with attacks against security objects; generate remediative steps against said attack kill-chains through remediation trend maps; prioritize remediative steps within the remediation trend maps; etc. There is therefore a need for optimal tools and structures that can achieve these benefits.

SUMMARY

(3) A system for testing a security object is disclosed. The system comprises one or more computing system processors and memory storing a plurality of security engines and instructions that, when executed by the one or more computing system processors, causes the system to: access a decision tree comprising a first node and a plurality of second nodes, wherein the plurality of second nodes comprise a first leaf node and a second leaf node. The one or more computing system processors are configured to link the first leaf node of the decision tree with a first security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines. The one or more computing system processors are also configured to link the second leaf node of the decision tree with a second security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines. The one or more computing system processors are further configured to: receive a security object comprising a digital asset that is attackable using one or more attack execution operations, or can be used to launch an attack against the system using one or more attack execution operations, or can serve as a mechanism through which an attack is launched against the system using one or more attack execution operations; and test the security object using the decision tree to determine a security threat parameter for the security object. Testing the security object using the decision tree comprises one or more of: determining, using the first the first security engine, whether the security object is associated with a blacklist of security objects, the blacklist of security objects comprising one or more of attack objects that are denied access to the system; classifying, using the first security engine, a malware sample associated with the security object as or into a threat category; determining, using the first security engine, a quantitative parameter (e.g., a number indicating a vulnerability level of the security object) or a qualitative parameter (e.g., an characterizations such as high severity, medium severity, or low severity associated with the vulnerability of the security object) to assign the security object; or determining, using the second security engine, one or more threat attribute data associated with the security object. The threat attribute data may comprise at least one of: a first threat attribute, a second threat attribute, a third threat attribute, or a fourth threat attribute.

(4) Other implementations of one or more of these aspects include corresponding systems, apparatus, and computer programs, configured to perform the actions of the methods, encoded on computer storage devices.

(5) These and other implementations may each optionally include one or more of the following features. The digital asset of the security object comprises one or more of: a file, a file hash, a network internet protocol, a universal resource locator, a domain name, a domain object, a file registry, and a mutex object. The mutex object may comprise one of: a mechanism serializing access to a resource on the system, and an object managing how the resource is shared among a multiple program thread.

(6) In one embodiment, classifying a malware sample associated with the security object as or into a threat category comprises categorizing the identified malware sample into a malware family based on a textual pattern or a binary pattern of the security object.

(7) In some embodiments, determining the security threat parameter for the security object comprises: generating a first risk parameter using the first security engine; generating a second risk parameter using the second security engine; and designating one of: the first risk parameter as comprised in the security threat parameter wherein the first risk parameter is greater in magnitude than the second risk parameter, and the second risk parameter as comprised in the security threat parameter wherein the second risk parameter is greater in magnitude than the first risk parameter.

(8) According to one embodiment, the first threat attribute comprises threat-actor data indicating an

attacker associated with the one or more attack execution operations. The second threat attribute may indicate malware data associated with the one or more attack execution operations. The third threat attribute may indicate a security tool used to execute the one or more one attack execution operations. The fourth threat attribute may comprise user data associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations.

(9) The threat attribute data may comprise one or more of: a fifth threat attribute comprising location data associated with the one or more attack execution operations; a sixth threat attribute comprising operating system data associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations; a seventh threat attribute comprising application package data indicative of package-access information associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations; an eighth threat attribute comprising sub-operation data associated with executing at least one sub-attack execution operation associated with the one or more attack execution operations; and a ninth threat attribute comprising remediation data associated with mitigating against the one or more one attack execution operations.

(10) In some cases, at least the first leaf node is connected to one or more third leaf nodes comprised in the plurality of second nodes. The one or more third leaf nodes may be associated with, or otherwise linked to a plurality of sub-engines. The plurality of sub-engines may be configured to execute at least one additional test on the security object subsequent to executing a security test using the first security engine.

(11) In one embodiment, testing the security object using the decision tree comprises one or more of: determining a malware category to assign the security object based on the quantitative or qualitative reputation parameter of the security object; testing the security object for one or more threat attribute data; testing the security object based on network threat intelligence data; testing the security object based on one or more of: vulnerability management data associated with the security object, policy compliance data associated with the security object, or file integrity data correlated to monitored security events associated with the security object.

(12) According to one embodiment, testing the security object using the decision tree comprises one or more of: determining whether the security object is associated with one of a process object, a mutex object, or a network object; and determining whether the security object indicates an activity associated with a security event comprised in the one or more attack execution operations.

(13) In some embodiments, the decision tree is structured based on one or more of: threat data derived from a threat-actor behavior, threat data associated with security reports, and threat data derived from the threat attribute data.

(14) In one embodiment, the security threat parameter is used to prioritize one or more remediation steps for mitigating against the one or more attack execution operations associated with the digital asset.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The disclosure is illustrated by way of example, and not by way of limitation in the figures of the accompanying drawings in which like reference numerals are used to refer to similar elements. It is emphasized that various features may not be drawn to scale and the dimensions of various features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion. Further, some components may be omitted in certain figures for clarity of discussion.

(2) FIG. 1 shows an exemplary system for testing security objects, in accordance with some embodiments of this disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a functional block diagram of a computing environment for testing security objects, in accordance with some embodiments of this disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 is a detailed system diagram of the computing environment of FIG. 2, in accordance with some embodiments of this disclosure.

(5) FIG. 4 shows an exemplary flowchart for generating a decision tree for testing security event files, in accordance with some embodiments of this disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 shows an exemplary flowchart for prioritizing remediation operations, in accordance with some embodiments of this disclosure.

(7) FIG. 6 shows an exemplary decision tree for testing security event files, in accordance with one embodiment of this disclosure.

(8) FIG. 7 shows an exemplary decision tree for testing security objects, in accordance with one embodiment of this disclosure.

(9) FIG. 8 shows an exemplary flowchart for testing a security object, in accordance with one embodiment of this disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) Most computer security systems require accurate or substantially accurate models for optimal detection and remediating against computer security breaches. For example, models that accurately quantify or otherwise characterize adversary tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs) using threat attributes and subsequent resulting analysis from correlating such TTPs to actual numerical values can quickly help in detecting and categorizing threat-actor (e.g., hacker) activity and/or provide recommendations, and/or prioritization of remediative operations against attack operations of threat-actors. In some cases, such models can be used to quantitatively ascribe severity parameters of TTPs using attribution and/or grouping criteria inherent in security events that have been aggregated over a period of time from multiple computing devices and/or from multiple similar or dissimilar entities. Leveraging data from the foregoing aggregated security data can automatically balance or otherwise normalize threat attributes across multiple, and in some cases, different TTPs associated with an adversary/threat actor kill-chain (e.g., one or more attack execution operations that comprise an attack campaign). This can help prioritize remediative operations within a set of operations that mitigate against the adversary kill-chain and/or enhance high fidelity detections of threat-actor activity as logged within a security event file or in some cases, associated with a security object.

(11) According to one aspect of the present disclosure, a decision tree (e.g., a decision tree model) is used to structure a plurality of threat attributes with specific numeric scores that map to corresponding TTPs. The decision tree may be used to test security event files that may include data associated with one or more attack execution operations of an attack campaign executed by a threat-actor. In some embodiments, alternate decision trees may test security objects associated with the attack campaign. An attack campaign could comprise a collection of TTPs used to execute an attack on a computing system. In one embodiment, tactics used to execute an attack campaign comprise a plurality of techniques that are aligned to a particular phase within the attack campaign. Moreover, a technique used in an attack campaign could include an action, step, or operation that a threat-actor performs to achieve a specific goal.

(12) In the computer security space, threat-actors or adversaries such as Advanced Persistent Threat (APT) groups and/or other hackers generally execute attack execution operations for myriad reasons when attacking computing devices and/or resources associated with a computing device. Attack execution operations could comprise one or more TTPs and/or practices used by a threat-actor to execute an attack campaign. As part of executing attack execution operations, threat-actors may seek vulnerabilities on computing devices, hold computing devices hostage via denial of service attacks, seek backdoor channels into computing devices to bypass normal authentication protocols, compromise computing devices using worms and keyloggers, eavesdrop, phish and spoof to obtain data, etc. Because of this, individuals and organizations generally have some form of computer security infrastructure that deal with threats posed by threat-actor activities.

(13) Usually, most users adopt computer security infrastructure that combine many security

features associated with one or more computer security products. The techniques disclosed herein facilitate leveraging data generated from one or more security features associated computer security products in a manner that provides a holistic or complete view into the content and context of an attack campaign executed against a computing system. More specifically, the techniques described herein advantageously facilitate mapping attack events associated with an attack campaign across a multitude of security products to security data from one or more attack repositories to generate a decision tree. The decision tree may include multiple nodes such that some of the nodes are linked to quantified threat attributes and/or security values that map to specific TTPs. The decision tree may be used to test security event files as further discussed below. In some embodiments, one or more nodes of the decision tree are linked to one or more security engines that are configured to test security objects.

(14) The techniques provided herein provide insight into how an attack campaign was or could be executed. In particular, the techniques discussed in this disclosure, according to some embodiments, allow quantifying vulnerabilities derived from attack data derived from a plurality of TTPs to provide automatic adaptation of remediation strategies that appropriately account for, and/or remediate against, a given attack campaign and/or attack steps comprised in a security event file or associated with a security object.

(15) System Environment

(16) Illustrated in FIG. 1 is a high level diagram of an exemplary system **100** for executing the principles disclosed. In the illustrated implementation, the system **100** may include a remote server **105** coupled to a network **110**. The system **100** may also include an endpoint device **125** and a public record repository **113** communicatively coupled via the network **110**. While a single remote server **105** and a single endpoint device **125** are illustrated, the disclosed principles and techniques could be expanded to include multiple remote servers, multiple endpoints, and multiple public record repositories.

(17) In some embodiments, the remote server **105** may include a computing device such as a mainframe server, a content server, a communication server, a laptop computer, a desktop computer, a handheld computing device, a smart phone, a wearable computing device, a tablet computing device, a virtual machine, a cloud-based computing solution and/or a cloud-based service, and/or the like. The remote server **105** may include a plurality of computing devices configured to communicate with one another and/or implement the techniques described herein.

(18) The remote server **105** may include various elements of a computing environment as described in association with the computing environment **200** of FIG. 2 and/or FIG. 3. For example, the remote server **105** may include processing unit **202**, a memory unit **204**, an input/output (I/O) unit **206**, and/or a communication unit **208**. The remote server **105** may further include subunits and/or other modules as for performing operations associated with malware detection and/or remediation. A user such as network administrator and/or computer security engineer may operate the remote server **105** either locally or remotely.

(19) Further, the remote server **105** may include a web server **115**, security infrastructure **140**, and a web and agent resources **160**. The web server **115**, the security infrastructure **140** and the web and agent resources **160** are coupled to each other and to the network **110** via one or more signal lines. The one or more signal lines may be a wired and/or wireless connection.

(20) The web server **115** may include a secure socket layer (SSL) proxy **145** for establishing HTTP-based connectivity **150** between the remote server **105** and other devices or systems coupled to the network **110**. Other forms of secure connection techniques, such as encryption, may be employed on the web server **115** and across other systems coupled to the network **110**.

Additionally, the web server **115** may deliver artifacts (e.g., binary code, instructions, data, etc.) to the security infrastructure **140** either directly via the SSL proxy **145** and/or via the network **110**.

Additionally, the web and agent resources **160** of the remote server **105** may be provided to the endpoint device **125** via the web app **165** on the web server **115**. The web and agent resources **160**

may be used to render a web-based graphical interface (GUI) **170** via the browser **155** running on the endpoint device **125**.

(21) The security infrastructure **140** may be on the remote server **105** and/or on the endpoint device **125**. Security infrastructure **140** may include one or more computer security products such as access control software, anti-keyloggers, anti-malware, anti-spyware, anti-subversion software, anti-tamper software, antivirus software, cryptographic software, computer-aided dispatch (CAD), Firewall (web or otherwise), Intrusion detection systems (IDS), Intrusion prevention systems (IPS), log management software, records management software, Sandboxes (e.g., a secure environment in which various computing processes may be executed), security information management software, security information and event management (SIEM) software, anti-theft software, parental control software, cloud-based security protection, and/or the like.

(22) In some embodiments, security infrastructure **140** can determine whether scan data is indicative of malware and whether a report indicating that the endpoint device **125**, or some other device coupled to the network **110** has been exposed to risks associated with malware. According to some embodiments, the report may comprise a security event file that includes a plurality of similar and/or dissimilar attack execution operations associated with an attack campaign. In other embodiments, the security event file may be associated with one or more attack steps that may or may not be associated with an attack campaign. The security event file may be associated with a listing of identified TTPs, threat attributes, a count of identified threat attributes, a type of each identified threat attribute, an identification of each malware family (e.g., a group of malware samples that have a common code base) and/or malware variant determined to be associated with the endpoint device **125**, and/or associated with another system coupled to the network **110**. The security event file may be stored on the local record repository **103** and/or on the public record repository **113** as the case may be. According to some embodiments, the security infrastructure may generate and/or receive security objects and subsequently tests the security object as further discussed in association with FIG. 8.

(23) The security infrastructure **140** may be configured to execute security operations including preparedness operations such as processes for dealing with security events/incidents/breaches/compromises; detection and analysis operations such as identifying and investigating suspicious activity associated with security events; containment, eradication, and recovery operations including determining the nature of a security event; and post-incident activity.

(24) In some embodiments, the security infrastructure **140** may access an operating system **180** of the endpoint device **125** in order to execute security operations. For instance, the security infrastructure **140** may gain access into the operating system **180** in order to scan a security posture of the endpoint device **125** by scanning a system configuration **185**, a file system **190**, and/or system services **195** of the endpoint device **125**. The plug-in **175** of the web browser **155** may provide needed downloads that facilitate operations executed by the operating system **180**, the security infrastructure **140**, and/or other applications running on the endpoint device **125**.

(25) The network **110** may include a plurality of networks. For instance, the network **110** may include any wired and/or wireless communication network that facilitates communication between the remote server **105**, the public record repository **113**, and the endpoint device **125**. The network **110**, in some instances, may include an Ethernet network, a cellular network, a computer network, the Internet, a wireless fidelity (Wi-Fi) network, a light fidelity (Li-Fi) network, a Bluetooth network, a radio frequency identification (RFID) network, a near-field communication (NFC) network, a laser-based network, and/or the like.

(26) Returning to FIG. 1, the public record repository **113** may be one or more storage devices that store data, information and instructions used by the remote server **105** and/or the endpoint device **125**. The stored information may include information about users, information about threat-actors or adversaries, information about TTPs and other malicious practices by threat-actors to execute an attack steps associated with an attack campaign. In one embodiment, the computer security

information may be captured from computing devices from multiple different organizations and stored in the public record repository **113**. In other embodiments, the computer security information stored in the public record repository **113** may be structured into a framework based on real-world observations of attacks on computing devices/systems across the globe. In some instances, this framework can provide comprehensive methods that assess tools/resources/components used by threat-actors to execute an attack campaign on a computing system. Additionally, the framework could also enable mapping security events detected on computing devices to numeric values or scores on a decision tree that correspond to a combination of TTPs within the public record repository **113**. This can be used to test attack steps comprised in a security event file in order to determine appropriate remediation steps. In some implementations, testing a security event file may facilitate determining TTPs comprised within the security event file, processes used by threat-actors to hide their attacks, methodologies used by threat-actors to stage their exploits, practices used by threat-actors to evade detection, weaknesses associated with a computing system that are leveraged by threat-actors, etc. The framework discussed above, in some instances, includes the MITRE ATT&CK framework where attacks are classified into discreet units to facilitate recognizing patterns associated with one or more attack steps or attack execution operations associated with an attack campaign.

(27) The one or more storage devices mentioned above in association with the public record repository **113** can be non-volatile memory or similar permanent storage device and media. For example, the one or more storage devices may include a hard disk drive, a CD-ROM device, a DVD-ROM device, a DVD-RAM device, a DVD-RW device, a flash memory device, solid state media, or some other mass storage device known in the art for storing information on a more permanent basis.

(28) While the public record repository **113** is shown as coupled to the remote server **105** and the endpoint device **125** via the network **110**, the data in the public record repository **113** may be replicated, in some embodiments, on the remote server **105** and/or the endpoint device **125**. That is to say that a local copy of the data in the public record repository **113** may be stored on the remote server **105** and/or the endpoint device **125**. This local copy may be synched with the public record repository **113** so that when there are any changes to the information in the public record repository **113**, the local copy is also accordingly updated in real-time or in near-real-time to be consistent with the information in the public record repository **113**.

(29) Turning back to FIG. **1**, the endpoint device **125** may be a handheld computing device, a smart phone, a tablet, a laptop computer, a desktop computer, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a smart device, a wearable device, a biometric device, a computer server, a virtual server, a virtual machine, and/or a communication server. In some embodiments, the endpoint device **125** may include a plurality of computing devices configured to communicate with one another and/or implement the techniques described in this disclosure. It is appreciated that according to some implementations, security event files (comprising one or more attack execution operations) may be generated by the security infrastructure **140** of the endpoint device **125** while the security infrastructure **140** of the remote server **105** may generate a decision tree used to subsequently test the security event file. In other embodiments, the security infrastructure **140** of the endpoint device **125** may also generate the decision tree used to test the security event file generated on the endpoint device **125**. In some cases the security infrastructure may access a decision tree to test a security object as further discussed below.

(30) The local record repository **103**, shown in association with the endpoint device **125**, may include one or more storage devices that store data, information, and instructions used by the endpoint device **125** and/or other devices coupled to the network **110**. The stored information may include various logs/records or security event files associated with captured security data/security events by the security infrastructure **140**. For example, the various reports, logs, data, security event files, etc., generated by the one or more security products of the security infrastructure **140**

may be stored in the local record repository.

(31) The one or more storage devices discussed above in association with the local record repository **103** can be non-volatile memory or similar permanent storage device and media. For example, the one or more storage devices may include a hard disk drive, a floppy disk drive, a CD-ROM device, a DVD-ROM device, a DVD-RAM device, a DVD-RW device, a flash memory device, solid state media, or some other mass storage device known in the art for storing information on a more permanent basis.

(32) The other elements of the endpoint device **125** are discussed in association with the computing environment **200** of FIG. 2 and/or FIG. 3. For example, elements such as a processing unit **202**, a memory unit **204**, an input/output (I/O) unit **206**, and/or a communication unit **208** may execute one or more of the modules of endpoint device **125** and/or one or more elements of the remote server **105** shown in FIG. 1. The endpoint device **125** may also include subunits and/or other computing instances as provided in this disclosure for performing operations associated with malware detection, and/or malware remediation.

(33) FIGS. 2 and 3 illustrate exemplary functional and system diagrams of a computing environment **200**, according to some embodiments of this disclosure, for generating and/or accessing a decision tree for threat analysis. Specifically, FIG. 2 provides a functional block diagram of the computing environment **200**, whereas FIG. 3 provides a detailed system diagram of the computing environment **200**.

(34) As seen in FIGS. 2 and 3, the computing environment **200** may include a processing unit **202**, a memory unit **204**, an I/O unit **206**, and a communication unit **208**. The processing unit **202**, the memory unit **204**, the I/O unit **206**, and the communication unit **208** may include one or more subunits for performing operations described in this disclosure. Additionally, each unit and/or subunit may be operatively and/or otherwise communicatively coupled with each other and to the network **110**. The computing environment **200** may be implemented on general-purpose hardware and/or specifically-purposed hardware as the case may be.

(35) Importantly, the computing environment **200** and any units and/or subunits of FIGS. 2 and/or 3 may be included in one or more elements of system **100** as described in association with FIG. 1. For example, one or more elements (e.g., units and/or subunits) of the computing environment **200** may be included in the remote server **105** and/or the endpoint device **125**.

(36) The processing unit **202** may control one or more of the memory unit **204**, the I/O unit **206**, and the communication unit **208** of the computing environment **200**, as well as any included subunits, elements, components, devices, and/or functions performed by the memory unit **204**, I/O unit **206**, and the communication unit **208**. The described sub-elements of the computing environment **200** may also be included in similar fashion in any of the other units and/or devices included in the system **100** of FIG. 1. Additionally, any actions described herein as being performed by a processor may be taken by the processing unit **202** of FIG. 2 and/or FIG. 3 alone and/or by the processing unit **202** in conjunction with one or more additional processors, units, subunits, elements, components, devices, and/or the like. Further, while one processing unit **202** may be shown in FIG. 2 and/or FIG. 3, multiple processing units may be present and/or otherwise included in the computing environment **200** or elsewhere in the overall system (e.g., system **100** of FIG. 1). Thus, while instructions may be described as being executed by the processing unit **202** (and/or various subunits of the processing unit **202**), the instructions may be executed simultaneously, serially, and/or otherwise by one or multiple processing units **202** on one or more devices. One or more computing device processors or computing system processors may be used to characterize the operation of the processing unit **202**, according to some embodiments.

(37) In some embodiments, the processing unit **202** may be implemented as one or more computer processing unit (CPU) chips and/or graphical processing unit (GPU) chips and may include a hardware device capable of executing computer instructions. The processing unit **202** may execute instructions, codes, computer programs, and/or scripts. The instructions, codes, computer

programs, and/or scripts may be received from and/or stored in the memory unit **204**, the I/O unit **206**, the communication unit **208**, subunits, and/or elements of the aforementioned units, other devices, and/or computing environments, and/or the like.

(38) In some embodiments, the processing unit **202** may include, among other elements, subunits such as a content management unit **212**, a location determination unit **214**, a graphical processing unit (GPU) **216**, and a resource allocation unit **218**. Each of the aforementioned subunits of the processing unit **202** may be communicatively and/or otherwise operably coupled with each other.

(39) The content management unit **212** may facilitate generation, modification, analysis, transmission, and/or presentation of content. Content may be file content, security event file content, media content, malware content, or any combination thereof. In some instances, content on which the content management unit **212** may operate includes device information, user interface data, images, text, themes, audio files, video files, documents, and/or the like. Additionally, the content management unit **212** may control the audio-visual environment and/or appearance of application data during execution of various processes (e.g., via web GUI **170** at the endpoint device **125**). In some embodiments, the content management unit **212** may interface with a third-party content server and/or memory location for execution of its operations.

(40) The location determination unit **214** may facilitate detection, generation, modification, analysis, transmission, and/or presentation of location information. Location information may include global positioning system (GPS) coordinates, an Internet protocol (IP) address, a media access control (MAC) address, geolocation information, a port number, a server number, a proxy name and/or number, device information (e.g., a serial number), an address, a zip code, and/or the like. In some embodiments, the location determination unit **214** may include various sensors, radar, and/or other specifically-purposed hardware elements for the location determination unit **214** to acquire, measure, and/or otherwise transform location information.

(41) The GPU **216** may facilitate generation, modification, analysis, processing, transmission, and/or presentation of content described above, as well as any data (e.g., scanning instructions, scan data, security event data, and/or the like) described herein. In some embodiments, the GPU **216** may be utilized to render content for presentation on a computing device (e.g., via web GUI **170** at the endpoint device **125**). The GPU **216** may also include multiple GPUs and therefore may be configured to perform and/or execute multiple processes in parallel. In some implementations, the GPU **216** may be used in conjunction with the tree generation unit **234**, the event scanning unit **236**, and/or other subunits associated with the memory unit **204**, the I/O unit **206**, the communication unit **208**, and/or a combination thereof.

(42) The resource allocation unit **218** may facilitate the determination, monitoring, analysis, and/or allocation of computing resources throughout the computing environment **200** and/or other computing environments. For example, the computing environment may facilitate a high volume of data (e.g., files, malware, malware variants, etc.), to be processed and analyzed. As such, computing resources of the computing environment **200** utilized by the processing unit **202**, the memory unit **204**, the I/O unit **206**, and/or the communication unit **208** (and/or any subunit of the aforementioned units) such as processing power, data storage space, network bandwidth, and/or the like may be in high demand at various times during operation. Accordingly, the resource allocation unit **218** may include sensors and/or other specially-purposed hardware for monitoring performance of each unit and/or subunit of the computing environment **200**, as well as hardware for responding to the computing resource needs of each unit and/or subunit. In some embodiments, the resource allocation unit **218** may utilize computing resources of a second computing environment separate and distinct from the computing environment **200** to facilitate a desired operation. For example, the resource allocation unit **218** may determine a number of simultaneous computing processes and/or requests. The resource allocation unit **218** may also determine that the number of simultaneous computing processes and/or requests meet and/or exceed a predetermined threshold value. Based on this determination, the resource allocation unit **218** may determine an amount of

additional computing resources (e.g., processing power, storage space of a particular non-transitory computer-readable memory medium, network bandwidth, and/or the like) required by the processing unit **202**, the memory unit **204**, the I/O unit **206**, the communication unit **208**, and/or any subunit of the aforementioned units for safe and efficient operation of the computing environment while supporting the number of simultaneous computing processes and/or requests. The resource allocation unit **218** may then retrieve, transmit, control, allocate, and/or otherwise distribute determined amount(s) of computing resources to each element (e.g., unit and/or subunit) of the computing environment **200** and/or another computing environment.

(43) The memory unit **204** may be utilized for storing, recalling, receiving, transmitting, and/or accessing various files and/or data (e.g., malware files, malware samples, scan data, and/or the like) during operation of computing environment **200**. For example, memory unit **204** may be used for storing, recalling, and/or updating scan history information as well as other data associated with, resulting from, and/or generated by any unit, or combination of units and/or subunits of the computing environment **200**. In some embodiments, the memory unit **204** may store instructions, code, and/or data that may be executed by the processing unit **202**. For instance, the memory unit **204** may store code that execute operations associated with one or more units and/or one or more subunits of the computing environment **200**. For example, the memory unit may store code for the processing unit **202**, the I/O unit **206**, the communication unit **208**, and for itself.

(44) In some embodiments, the memory unit **204** may store instructions associated with flowcharts **400**, **500**, and **800** as further discussed below. In addition, the memory unit **204** may store one or more security engines as further discussed in association with FIGS. **7** and **8**.

(45) Memory unit **204** may include various types of data storage media such as solid state storage media, hard disk storage media, virtual storage media, and/or the like. Memory unit **204** may include dedicated hardware elements such as hard drives and/or servers, as well as software elements such as cloud-based storage drives. In some implementations, memory unit **204** may be a random access memory (RAM) device, a dynamic random access memory (DRAM) device, a static random access memory (SRAM) device, flash memory, read only memory (ROM) device, and/or various forms of secondary storage. The RAM device may be used to store volatile data and/or to store instructions that may be executed by the processing unit **202**. For example, the instructions stored by the RAM device may be a command, a current operating state of computing environment **200**, an intended operating state of computing environment **200**, and/or the like. As a further example, data stored in the RAM device of memory unit **204** may include instructions related to various methods and/or functionalities described herein. The ROM device may be a non-volatile memory device that may have a smaller memory capacity than the memory capacity of a secondary storage. The ROM device may be used to store instructions and/or data that may be read during execution of computer instructions. In some embodiments, access to both the RAM device and ROM device may be faster to access than the secondary storage.

(46) Secondary storage may comprise one or more disk drives and/or tape drives and may be used for non-volatile storage of data or as an over-flow data storage device if the RAM device is not large enough to hold all working data. Secondary storage may be used to store programs that may be loaded into the RAM device when such programs are selected for execution. In some embodiments, the memory unit **204** may include one or more databases **310** (shown in FIG. **3**) for storing any data described herein. For example, depending on the implementation, the one or more databases may be used as the local record repository **103** of the endpoint device discussed with reference to FIG. **1**. Additionally or alternatively, one or more secondary databases (e.g., the public record repository **113** discussed with reference to FIG. **1**) located remotely from computing environment **200** may be used and/or accessed by memory unit **204**. In some embodiments, memory unit **204** and/or its subunits may be local to the remote server **105** and/or the endpoint device **125** and/or remotely located in relation to the remote server **105** and/or the endpoint device **125**.

(47) Turning back to FIG. 2, the memory unit **204** may include subunits such as an operating system unit **226**, an application data unit **228**, an application programming interface (API) unit **230**, a content storage unit **232**, security infrastructure **140**, and a cache storage unit **240**. Each of the aforementioned subunits of the memory unit **204** may be communicatively and/or otherwise operably coupled with each other and other units and/or subunits of the computing environment **200**. It is also noted that the memory unit **204** may include other modules, instructions, or code that facilitate the execution of the techniques described. For instance, the memory unit **204** may include one or more modules such as a tree generation unit **234** and an event scanning unit (not shown), and/or an object testing unit **236**.

(48) The operating system unit **226** may facilitate deployment, storage, access, execution, and/or utilization of an operating system utilized by computing environment **200** and/or any other computing environment described herein. In some embodiments, operating system unit **226** may include various hardware and/or software elements that serve as a structural framework for processing unit **202** to execute various operations described herein. Operating system unit **226** may further store various pieces of information and/or data associated with the operation of the operating system and/or computing environment **200** as a whole, such as a status of computing resources (e.g., processing power, memory availability, resource utilization, and/or the like), runtime information, modules to direct execution of operations described herein, user permissions, security credentials, and/or the like.

(49) The application data unit **228** may facilitate deployment, storage, access, execution, and/or utilization of an application utilized by computing environment **200** and/or any other computing environment described herein. For example, the endpoint device **125** may be required to download, install, access, and/or otherwise utilize a software application (e.g., web application **165**) to facilitate performance of malware scanning operations and/or kill chain graph generation and/or asset remediation trend map generation as described herein. As such, application data unit **228** may store any information and/or data associated with an application. Application data unit **228** may further store various pieces of information and/or data associated with the operation of an application and/or computing environment **200** as a whole, such as a status of computing resources (e.g., processing power, memory availability, resource utilization, and/or the like), runtime information, user interfaces, modules to direct execution of operations described herein, user permissions, security credentials, and/or the like.

(50) The API unit **230** may facilitate deployment, storage, access, execution, and/or utilization of information associated with APIs of computing environment **200** and/or any other computing environment described herein. For example, computing environment **200** may include one or more APIs for various devices, applications, units, subunits, elements, and/or other computing environments to communicate with each other and/or utilize the same data. Accordingly, API unit **230** may include API databases containing information that may be accessed and/or utilized by applications, units, subunits, elements, and/or operating systems of other devices and/or computing environments. In some embodiments, each API database may be associated with a customized physical circuit included in memory unit **204** and/or API unit **230**. Additionally, each API database may be public and/or private, and so authentication credentials may be required to access information in an API database. In some embodiments, the API unit **230** may enable the remote server **105** and the endpoint device **125** to communicate with each other.

(51) The content storage unit **232** may facilitate deployment, storage, access, and/or utilization of information associated with performance of malware scanning operations and/or framework processes by computing environment **200** and/or any other computing environment described herein. In some embodiments, content storage unit **232** may communicate with content management unit **212** to receive and/or transmit content files (e.g., media content).

(52) Security infrastructure **140** may include at least a tree generation unit, an event scanning unit (not shown), and an object testing unit **236**. According to some implementations, the security

infrastructure may also include a threat detection unit (not shown) and/or a scan history unit (not shown). The tree generation unit **234** may store instructions associated with one or more security products of security infrastructure **140** that facilitate the generation and/or access of one or more decision trees for testing security event files and/or for testing security objects. These aspects are further discussed below.

(53) The event scanning unit of the memory unit may be used in conjunction with the threat detection unit (not shown) and may store instructions associated with access control software, anti-keyloggers, anti-malware, anti-spyware, anti-subversion software, anti-tamper software, antivirus software, cryptographic software, computer-aided dispatch (CAD), Firewall (web or otherwise), Intrusion detection systems (IDS), Intrusion prevention systems (IPS), log management software, records management software, Sandboxes (e.g., a secure environment in which various computing processes may be executed), security information management, security information and event management (STEM) software, anti-theft software, parental control software, cloud-based security protection, and/or the like. It is appreciated that the event scanning unit may generate one or more security reports or security event files that include one or more attack steps executed by a threat-actor, one or more attack steps associated with an attack campaign launched by a threat actor, etc.

(54) Moreover, the event scanning unit may also be used in conjunction with the scan history unit (not shown) to facilitate deployment, storage, access, analysis, and/or utilization of scan data, and/or security event data comprised in a security event file, and/or other received data resulting from scanning or executing some other security operation on the endpoint device **125**. For example, the event scanning unit may store instructions associated with each operation that involves file scanning, malware file execution, malware detection, security event file generation, and/or the other operations executed by security products of security infrastructure **140**. Information stored in tree generation unit **234** and event scanning unit may be used by the content management unit **212**, GPU **216**, threat detection unit, and/or other units and/or subunits of computing environment **200**. It is appreciated that information generated by or associated with the tree generation unit **234** and/or event scanning unit may be stored in the local record repository **103** and/or the public record repository **113** of FIG. 1.

(55) The object testing unit **236** may be used to test security objects that are generated and/or provided by the security infrastructure. According to some implementations, security infrastructure **140** may access a decision tree with a plurality of nodes that are linked to security engines stored in the memory unit **204**. Security infrastructure may then test the security object using the decision tree.

(56) The cache storage unit **240** may facilitate short-term deployment, storage, access, analysis, and/or utilization of data. In some embodiments, cache storage unit **240** may serve as a short-term storage location for data so that the data stored in cache storage unit **240** may be accessed quickly. In some instances, cache storage unit **240** may include RAM devices and/or other storage media types for quick recall of stored data. Cache storage unit **240** may include a partitioned portion of storage media included in memory unit **204**.

(57) The I/O unit **206** may include hardware and/or software elements for the computing environment **200** to receive, transmit, and/or present information useful for performing malware scanning operations, tree generation operations, security event file testing, and/or other processes as described herein. For example, elements of the I/O unit **206** may be used to receive input from a user of the endpoint device **125**. As described herein, I/O unit **206** may include subunits such as an I/O device **242**, an I/O calibration unit **244**, and/or driver **246**.

(58) The I/O device **242** may facilitate the receipt, transmission, processing, presentation, display, input, and/or output of information as a result of executed processes described herein. In some embodiments, the I/O device **242** may include a plurality of I/O devices. In some embodiments, I/O device **242** may include a variety of elements that enable a user to interface with computing environment **200**. For example, I/O device **242** may include a keyboard, a touchscreen, a button, a

sensor, a biometric scanner, a laser, a microphone, a camera, and/or another element for receiving and/or collecting input from a user. Additionally and/or alternatively, I/O device **242** may include a display, a screen, a sensor, a vibration mechanism, a light emitting diode (LED), a speaker, a radio frequency identification (RFID) scanner, and/or another element for presenting and/or otherwise outputting data to a user. In some embodiments, the I/O device **242** may communicate with one or more elements of processing unit **202** and/or memory unit **204** to execute operations associated with malware scanning, detection, displaying visual representations of attack steps used in attack campaigns associated with the malware scanning and detections, displaying visual representations of remediation strategies against an attack campaign, and other operations described herein.

(59) The I/O calibration unit **244** may facilitate the calibration of the I/O device **242**. For example, I/O calibration unit **244** may detect and/or determine one or more settings of I/O device **242**, and then adjust and/or modify settings so that the I/O device **242** may operate more efficiently.

(60) In some embodiments, I/O calibration unit **244** may utilize a driver **246** (or multiple drivers) to calibrate I/O device **242**. For example, driver **246** may include software that is to be installed by I/O calibration unit **244** so that an element of computing environment **200** (or an element of another computing environment) may recognize and/or integrate with I/O device **242** for the malware scanning operations and/or framework processes described herein.

(61) The communication unit **208** may facilitate establishment, maintenance, monitoring, and/or termination of communications between computing environment **200** and other computing environments, third party server systems, and/or the like (e.g., between the remote server **105** and the endpoint device **125**). Communication unit **208** may also facilitate internal communications between various elements (e.g., units and/or subunits) of computing environment **200**. In some embodiments, communication unit **208** may include a network protocol unit **248**, an API gateway **250**, an encryption engine **252**, and/or a communication device **254**. Communication unit **208** may include hardware and/or software elements.

(62) The network protocol unit **248** may facilitate establishment, maintenance, and/or termination of a communication connection for computing environment **200** by way of a network. For example, network protocol unit **248** may detect and/or define a communication protocol required by a particular network and/or network type. Communication protocols utilized by network protocol unit **248** may include Wi-Fi protocols, Li-Fi protocols, cellular data network protocols, Bluetooth® protocols, WiMAX protocols, Ethernet protocols, powerline communication (PLC) protocols, and/or the like. In some embodiments, facilitation of communication for computing environment **200** may include transforming and/or translating data from being compatible with a first communication protocol to being compatible with a second communication protocol. In some embodiments, network protocol unit **248** may determine and/or monitor an amount of data traffic to consequently determine which particular network protocol is to be used for establishing a secure communication connection, transmitting data, and/or performing malware scanning operations and/or other processes described herein.

(63) The API gateway **250** may allow other devices and/or computing environments to access API unit **230** of memory unit **204** of computing environment **200**. For example, an endpoint device **125** may access API unit **230** of computing environment **200** via API gateway **250**. In some embodiments, API gateway **250** may be required to validate user credentials associated with a user of an endpoint device prior to providing access to API unit **230** to a user. API gateway **250** may include instructions for computing environment **200** to communicate with another device and/or between elements of the computing environment **200**.

(64) The encryption engine **252** may facilitate translation, encryption, encoding, decryption, and/or decoding of information received, transmitted, and/or stored by the computing environment **200**. Using encryption engine **252**, each transmission of data may be encrypted, encoded, and/or translated for security reasons, and any received data may be encrypted, encoded, and/or translated prior to its processing and/or storage. In some embodiments, encryption engine **252** may generate

an encryption key, an encoding key, a translation key, and/or the like, which may be transmitted along with any data content.

(65) The communication device **254** may include a variety of hardware and/or software specifically purposed to facilitate communication for computing environment **200**. In some embodiments, communication device **254** may include one or more radio transceivers, chips, analog front end (AFE) units, antennas, processing units, memory, other logic, and/or other components to implement communication protocols (wired or wireless) and related functionality for facilitating communication for computing environment **200**. Additionally and/or alternatively, communication device **254** may include a modem, a modem bank, an Ethernet device such as a router or switch, a universal serial bus (USB) interface device, a serial interface, a token ring device, a fiber distributed data interface (FDDI) device, a wireless local area network (WLAN) device and/or device component, a radio transceiver device such as code division multiple access (CDMA) device, a global system for mobile communications (GSM) radio transceiver device, a universal mobile telecommunications system (UMTS) radio transceiver device, a long term evolution (LTE) radio transceiver device, a worldwide interoperability for microwave access (WiMAX) device, and/or another device used for communication purposes.

(66) Decision Tree Generation for Testing Security Event Files

(67) FIG. **4** shows an example flowchart for generating a decision tree for testing security event files. The method comprises receiving, at **402**, attack data comprising a plurality of attack execution operations. At **404**, threat attribute data may be determined based on the attack data. The threat attribute data may comprise data associated with a plurality of threat attributes. For example, the threat attribute data may comprise a first threat attribute associated with the plurality of attack execution operations comprised in the attack data. The first threat attribute data may comprise threat-actor data indicative of an attacker associated with at least one attack execution operation comprised in the plurality of attack execution operations. The threat attribute data may also comprise a second threat attribute associated with the plurality of attack execution operations. The second threat attribute may be indicative of malware data associated with at least one attack execution operation comprised in the aforementioned plurality of attack execution operations. In some embodiments, the threat attribute data comprises a third threat attribute associated with the plurality of attack execution operations. The third threat attribute may be indicative of security tool data associated with the at least one attack execution operation comprised in the plurality of attack execution operations. The threat attribute data may also comprise a fourth threat attribute associated with the plurality of attack execution operations. The fourth threat attribute may comprise user data associated with at least one attack execution operation comprised in the plurality of attack execution operations. In other embodiments, the threat attribute data includes a fifth threat attribute associated with the plurality of attack execution operations. The fifth threat attribute may comprise location data associated with an attack execution operation comprised in the plurality of attack execution operations. The threat attribute data may also comprise a sixth threat attribute associated with the plurality of attack execution operations. The sixth threat attribute may comprise operating system data associated with executing at least one attack execution operation comprised in the plurality of attack execution operations.

(68) At **406**, the method may generate a decision tree using the threat attribute data. The decision tree may include at least one first node and a plurality of second nodes connected to the at least one first node. For example, and as shown in FIG. **6**, the decision tree **600** may include a first node (e.g., node “a”) and a plurality of second nodes (e.g., node “b” to node “(n+1)”) where n is a positive integer). A first nodal data may be generated and assigned to each second node based on at least one of the first threat attribute, the second threat attribute, the third threat attribute, the fourth threat attribute, the fifth threat attribute, or the sixth threat attribute. In response to receiving a security event file, the method may comprise executing one or more security tests, using the decision tree, for the security event file. It is appreciated that the operations discussed in

association with steps **402-406** may be executed by at least the tree generation unit **234** discussed in association with FIGS. **2** and **3**.

(69) According to some implementations, the decision tree models or otherwise “consumes” threat attribute data such as TTPs from a repository (e.g., local record repository **103** and/or public record repository **113**) that stores multiple threat attribute data from a plurality of sources including intelligent sources and/or unintelligent sources associated multiple computing devices from multiple similar or dissimilar entities. Intelligent sources may include sources that use artificial intelligence (AI) or machine learning (ML) techniques in threat detection, threat attribute classification, and/or threat attribute analysis. For example, intelligent sources may include a data security framework such as the MITRE ATT&CK framework. Unintelligent sources may include systems that may not use AI or ML techniques in threat detection, threat attribute classification, and/or threat attribute analysis. In one embodiment, scores may be computed for each threat attribute identified or retrieved from the intelligent and/or unintelligent sources. By way of an example, a score may be generated based on the following attributes: (i) `used_by_groups`: The technique is used by 1 or more threat actor groups; (ii) `used_by_malware`: The technique is leveraged by 1 or more malware families; (iii) `used_by_tools`: The technique is used by 1 or more security tools; (iv) `needs_user_permissions`: The technique requires user-level privileges to execute; (v) `needs_remote_support`: The technique can be executed remotely on a target system; (vi) `needs_administrator_permissions`: The technique requires administrator-level privileges to execute; (vii) `needs_system_permissions`: The technique requires Windows SYSTEM privileges to execute; (viii) `needs_root_permissions`: The technique requires *nix root user privileges to execute; (ix) `has_subtechniques`: The technique has 1 or more sub-techniques; (x) `lacks_mitigations`: The technique lacks mitigation or remediation actions.

As seen above, each malware attribute may be given an identifier that names the attribute in question. For example, the first threat attribute “[t]he technique is used by 1 or more threat actor groups has the identifier “`used_by_groups`.” Similarly, the second attribute is identified by “`used_by_malware`,” and so forth.

(70) Based on the above threat attributes (and also other threat attributes that are not listed above), nodal data may be generated for each first node and second node of the decision tree. Nodal data may include a score (e.g., numerical value) associated with a specific attribute at a given node of the decision tree. The score for each node of a given decision tree may range from 0-10 with resolution of about 0.2 or 0.3 or 0.4 or 0.5, for example. In some cases, the score of the each node of the decision tree may range from 0-10, or from 0-20, or from 0-30, or from 0-40, or from 0-50, or from 0-60, or from 0-70, or from 0-80, or from 0-90, or from 0-100. It is appreciated that the decision tree can dynamically expand based on the amount of applicable threat attributes associated with the attack data.

(71) In one embodiment, moving from a first node (e.g., node “a” in FIG. **6**) to a second node (e.g., nodes “b”, “c”, “d”, etc.), may comprise increasing the score of the second node relative to the score of first node or reducing a score of the second node relative to the score of the first node. These increases or reductions of the score of the second node relative to the score of the first node may be based on the type of threat attribute assigned to the second node. It is appreciated that the first node, and/or the plurality of second nodes may be associated with specific threat attributes and inter-relate to each other. For example, a first second node “c” (see FIG. **6**) may comprise a threat attribute that is a subset of a threat attribute comprised in associated with the second node “b.” In another example, the first second node “c” may refer to a threat attribute that further clarifies one or more attack execution operations associated with the second node “b”.

(72) The security event file discussed in association with step **406** of FIG. **4** may comprise at least one attack type, such that executing one or more security tests for the security event file using the decision tree comprises: determining a risk value to assign the security event file, assigning the risk value to the security event file, and prioritizing one or more remediation operations against the at

least one attack type as shown at steps **502-506** of FIG. 5. In some cases, the risk value indicates the severity of the attack type associated with the security event file. For example, a risk value of 10 may indicate a high severity of the attack type associated with the security event file while an attack type having a risk value of about 1 may indicate a low severity of the attack type associated with the security event file. Moreover, a risk value of the security event file may be used to customize or otherwise adapt remediation strategies against one or more attack steps or attack execution operations associated with the attack type comprised in the security event file.

(73) In one embodiment, the nodal data may include a first nodal data that comprises a first score assigned to a first leaf node (e.g., node “b” or node “c”, etc.) comprised in the plurality of second nodes of the decision tree, such that the first score includes a combination of: a second score associated with a second leaf node comprised in the plurality of second nodes of the decision tree, and a third score associated with a third leaf node comprised in the plurality of second nodes of the decision tree.

(74) The threat attribute data may further comprise one or more of: a seventh threat attribute associated with the plurality of attack execution operations. The seventh threat attribute may comprise application package data indicative of package-access information associated with executing at least one attack execution operation comprised in the plurality of attack execution operations. The threat attribute data may also comprise an eighth threat attribute associated with the plurality of attack execution operations. The eighth threat attribute may comprise sub-operation data associated with executing at least one sub-attack execution operation associated with at least one attack execution operation comprised in the plurality of attack execution operations discussed in association with step **402** above. The threat attribute data may also comprise a ninth threat attribute associated with the plurality of attack execution operations. The ninth threat attribute may comprise remediation data associated with mitigating against at least one attack execution operation comprised in the plurality of attack execution operations. It is appreciated that in some embodiments, the decision tree is generated based on the seventh threat attribute, the eighth threat attribute, and the ninth threat attribute in addition to/without the first threat attribute, the second threat attribute, the third threat attribute, the fourth threat attribute, the fifth threat attribute, and the sixth threat attribute.

(75) In some cases, the threat attribute data is used to automatically structure one or more parent nodes and child nodes of the decision tree. Furthermore, the attack data comprises one or more of: a framework based on an attack repository; the attack repository comprising one or more of the attacker or one or more attackers associated with the plurality of attack execution operations; attack data captured from multiple computing devices associated with multiple entities; and one or more resources associated with the multiple computing devices.

(76) Furthermore, the malware data discussed in association with FIG. 4 may comprise a group of malware samples that have a common code base. The user data may comprise user credential data or administrator credential data. The location data may comprise data that indicates whether at least one attack execution operation was locally executed or remotely executed relative to a location of one or more computing devices upon which an attack by a threat-actor was launched.

(77) Moreover, the first nodal data may be based on a grouping of a plurality of threat attributes correlated to threat tactics, threat techniques, or threat procedures associated with a framework (e.g., MITRE ATT&CK framework) from which the threat data or attack data was pulled. In addition, the decision tree may automatically balance threat attributes across different tactics associated with the framework to generate an attack kill-chain associated with the security event file. The attack kill-chain may indicate one or more attack execution operations for executing an attack campaign such that the one or more security tests conducted on the security event file using the decision tree may generate remediation data comprising security operations that mitigate against the attack kill-chain. In particular, the decision tree may be used to customize or otherwise adapt specific and effective remediation steps or remediation operations against the attack kill-

chain. In some embodiments, the decision tree maps threat tactics, threat techniques, and threat practices associated with the framework to one or more scores assigned to one or more nodes of the decision tree.

(78) Decision Tree for Testing Security Objects

(79) A decision tree **700** (FIG. 7) for testing a security object is now discussed. This decision tree may be structured based on threat data derived from threat-actor behavior such as those discussed in association with FIGS. 4-6. The decision tree may also be based on threat data associated with security reports such as security reports derived from security analytics, AI or ML security reports, scan data, or other threat data derived from the threat attribute data discussed in conjunction with the decision tree **600**. In one embodiment, the decision tree **700** may comprise a first node “a1” and a plurality of second nodes (e.g., b1, b2, c1, c2, c3, c4, d1, d2, e1, e2, . . . n1, n2, o1, o2, o3, and o4). One or more of the second nodes may be linked with a security engine comprised in a plurality of security engines. For example, a first leaf node (e.g., b1) may be linked to a blacklist security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines. Similarly, a second leaf node (e.g., b2) may be linked to a behavioral engine. In some instance, a node of the second leaf node (e.g., c3) may be linked to, or otherwise associated with the first node (e.g., a) of FIG. 6. These and other aspects are discussed in association with FIG. 8.

(80) It is appreciated that the exemplary system **100** may include one or more computing device or computing system processors and memory storing a plurality of security engines and instructions, that when executed by the one or more computing device processors causes the system **100** to execute the various operations of FIG. 8. At **802**, the system **100** accesses a decision tree (e.g., decision tree **700**) comprising a first node and a plurality of second nodes. The plurality of second nodes may comprise a first leaf node (e.g., b1) and a second leaf node (e.g., b2). The one or more computing device processors of the system **100** may link, at **804**, the first leaf node of the decision tree with a first security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines. The one or more computing device processors of the system **100** may also link, at **806**, the second leaf node of the decision tree with a second security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines. The one or more computing device processors may receive, at **808**, a security object comprising a digital asset that is attackable (e.g., a security object that is vulnerable to being exploited or can otherwise be attacked by a threat-actor), or can be used to launch an attack by a threat-actor. The threat-actor may use one or more attack execution operations to exploit or attack the digital asset. At **810**, the one or more computing device processors may test the security object using the decision tree (e.g., decision tree **700**) to determine a security threat parameter for the security object. Testing the security object using the decision tree may comprises one or more of: determining, using the first the first security engine, whether the security object is associated with a blacklist of security objects; classifying, using the first security engine, a malware sample associated with the security object as, or into a threat category; determining, using the first security engine, a quantitative or a qualitative reputation parameter to assign the security object; or determining, using the second security engine, one or more threat attribute data associated with the security object. The blacklist of security objects may comprise one or more of attack objects that are denied access to the system (e.g., system **100**). The threat attribute data may comprise at least one of: a first threat attribute, a second threat attribute, a third threat attribute, or a fourth threat attribute.

(81) It is appreciated that the digital asset discussed in association with the security object may comprise one or more of: a file, a file hash, a network internet protocol, a universal resource locator, a domain name, a domain object, a file registry, and a mutex object. The mutex object may comprise a mechanism that serializes access to a resource on the system (e.g., system **100**). The mutex object may also or optionally manage how the resource of the computing system (e.g., system **100**) is shared among a multiple program thread.

(82) In one embodiment, classifying a malware sample associated with the security object as, or into a threat category may comprise categorizing the malware sample into a malware family based

on a textual pattern or a binary pattern of the security object.

(83) In some embodiments, determining the security threat parameter for the security object comprises: generating a first risk parameter using the first security engine; generating a second risk parameter using the second security engine; and designating one of: the first risk parameter as comprised in the security threat parameter wherein the first risk parameter is greater in magnitude than the second risk parameter; and the second risk parameter as comprised in the security threat parameter wherein the second risk parameter is greater in magnitude than the first risk parameter.

(84) According to one embodiment, the first threat attribute comprises threat-actor data indicating an attacker associated with the one or more attack execution operations. The second threat attribute may indicate malware data associated with the one or more attack execution operations. The third threat attribute may indicate a security tool used to execute the one or more one attack execution operations. The fourth threat attribute may comprise user data associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations.

(85) The threat attribute data may comprise one or more of: a fifth threat attribute comprising location data associated with the one or more attack execution operations; a sixth threat attribute comprising operating system data associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations; a seventh threat attribute comprising application package data indicative of package-access information associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations; an eighth threat attribute comprising sub-operation data associated with executing at least one sub-attack execution operation associated with the one or more attack execution operations; and a ninth threat attribute comprising remediation data associated with mitigating against the one or more one attack execution operations.

(86) In some cases, at least the first leaf node (e.g., leaf node b1 of FIG. 7) is connected to one or more third leaf nodes (e.g., c2, d2, e1, e2, n1, and n2) comprised in the plurality of second nodes. The one or more third leaf nodes may be associated with or otherwise linked to a plurality of sub-engines. These plurality of sub-engines may be configured to execute at least one additional test on the security object subsequent to executing a security test using the first security engine.

(87) In one embodiment, testing the security object using the decision tree (e.g., using one or more third leaf nodes of the decision tree **700**) comprises one or more of: determining a malware category to assign the security object based on the quantitative or qualitative reputation parameter of the security object; testing the security object for one or more threat attribute data; testing the security object based on network threat intelligence data; and testing the security object based a security data factor. The security data factor may comprise one or more of: vulnerability management data associated with the security object, policy compliance data associated with the security object, or file integrity data correlated to one or more monitored security events associated with the security object.

(88) According to one embodiment, testing the security object using the decision tree (e.g., decision tree **700**) comprises determining whether the security object is associated with one of a process object, a mutex object, or a network object. Testing the security object using the decision tree (e.g., decision tree **700**) comprises determining whether the security object indicates an activity associated with a security event comprised in, or otherwise associated with, the one or more attack execution operations.

(89) In some embodiments, the decision tree is structured based on one or more of: threat data derived from a threat-actor behavior, threat data associated with security reports, and threat data derived from the threat attribute data. In some instances, the security reports may comprise security analytics obtained from machine learning or artificial intelligence driven security systems, scan data, and like security reports.

(90) In one embodiment, the security threat parameter is used to prioritize one or more remediation steps for mitigating against the one or more attack execution operations associated with the digital asset. In some cases, the security threat parameter comprises a numerical quantity (e.g., a number)

that characterizes the security object as highly risky, moderately risky, or less risky. According to some embodiments, the security threat parameter provides an indication of steps comprised in the one or more attack execution operations associated with the digital assets. This facilitates high fidelity threat detections associated with the security object and prioritization of remediative operations by the security infrastructure **140** of the system **100** against said threat detections. It is further appreciated that the decision trees provided by FIG. 7 and/or FIG. 6 facilitate quantifying or classifying security threats associated with security objects and/or security event files based on collected threat attributes associated with the security object. Moreover, the decision tree of at least FIG. 7 can auto-balance threat verdicts or threat detections from multiple computing devices comprised in the system **100**, or associated with the system **100** to prioritize threat detections of the security object. The system **100** may be comprised in, or comprise one or more computing devices with processors that execute the foregoing operations.

(91) In the preceding description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the disclosure. It will be apparent, however, that the disclosure can be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, structures and devices have been shown in block diagram form in order to avoid obscuring the disclosure. For example, the present disclosure has been described in some implementations above with reference to interfaces and particular hardware. However, the present disclosure applies to any type of computing device that can receive data and commands, and any devices providing security services.

(92) Reference in the specification to “one implementation” or “an implementation” or “one embodiment” or “some embodiments” means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the implementation/embodiment is included in at least one implementation of the disclosure. The appearances of the phrase “in one implementation/embodiment” or “in some implementations/embodiments” in various places in the specification are not necessarily all referring to the same implementation/embodiment.

(93) Some portions of the detailed descriptions above are presented in terms of algorithms, modules, and symbolic representations of operations on data bits within a computer memory. These descriptions and representations are the means used by those skilled in data processing arts to most effectively convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art.

(94) The present disclosure also relates to an apparatus for performing the operations disclosed. This apparatus may be specially constructed for the required purposes, or it may include a general-purpose computer selectively activated or reconfigured by a computer program stored in the computer. Such a computer program may be stored in a computer readable storage medium, for example, any type of disk including floppy disks, optical disks, CD-ROMs, and magnetic disks, read-only memories (ROMs), random access memories (RAMs), EPROMs, EEPROMs, magnetic or optical cards, flash memories including USB keys with non-volatile memory or any type of media suitable for storing electronic instructions, each coupled to a computer system bus.

(95) The disclosure can take the form of an entirely hardware implementation, an entirely software implementation or an implementation containing both hardware and software elements. In some implementations, the disclosure is implemented in software, which includes but is not limited to firmware, resident software, microcode, etc.

(96) Furthermore, the disclosure can take the form of a computer program product accessible from a computer-usable or computer-readable medium providing program code for use by or in connection with a computer or any instruction execution system. For the purposes of this description, a computer-usable or computer-readable medium can be any apparatus that can contain, store, communicate, propagate, or transport the program for use by or in connection with the instruction execution system, apparatus, or device.

(97) A data processing system suitable for storing and/or executing program code will include at least one processor coupled directly or indirectly to memory elements through a system bus. The

memory elements can include local memory employed during actual execution of the program code, bulk storage, and cache memories which provide temporary storage of at least some program code in order to reduce the number of times code must be retrieved from bulk storage during execution.

(98) Input/output or I/O devices (including but not limited to keyboards, displays, pointing devices, etc.) can be coupled to the system either directly or through intervening I/O controllers.

(99) Network adapters may also be coupled to the system to enable the data processing system to become coupled to other data processing systems or remote printers or storage devices through intervening private or public networks. Modems, cable modems and Ethernet cards are just a few of the currently available types of network adapters.

(100) The algorithms and displays presented herein are not inherently related to any particular computer or other apparatus. Various general-purpose systems may be used with programs in accordance with the teachings herein, or it may prove convenient to construct more specialized apparatus to perform the required method steps. The required structure for a variety of these systems will appear from the description below. In addition, the present disclosure is not described with reference to any particular programming language. It will be appreciated that a variety of programming languages may be used to implement the teachings of the disclosure as described herein.

(101) Finally, the foregoing description of the implementations of the present disclosure has been presented for the purposes of illustration and description. It is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the present disclosure to the precise form disclosed. Many modifications and variations are possible in light of the above teaching. It is intended that the scope of the present disclosure be limited not by this detailed description, but rather by the claims of this application. As will be understood by those familiar with the art, the present disclosure may be embodied in other specific forms without departing from the spirit or essential characteristics thereof. Likewise, the particular naming and division of the modules, routines, features, attributes, methodologies and other aspects are not mandatory or significant, and the mechanisms that implement the present disclosure or its features may have different names, divisions and/or formats. Furthermore, the relevant art, the modules, routines, features, attributes, methodologies and other aspects of the present disclosure can be implemented as software, hardware, firmware or any combination of the three. Also, wherever a component, an example of which is a module, of the present disclosure is implemented as software, the component can be implemented as a standalone program, as part of a larger program, as a plurality of separate programs, as a statically or dynamically linked library, as a kernel loadable module, as a device driver, and/or in every and any other way known now or in the future in the art of computer programming. Additionally, the present disclosure is in no way limited to implementation in any specific programming language, or for any specific operating system or environment. Accordingly, the disclosure of the present disclosure is intended to be illustrative, but not limiting, of the scope of the present disclosure, which is set forth in the following claims.

Claims

1. A system comprising: one or more hardware computing system processors; and memory storing a plurality of security engines and instructions that, when executed by the one or more hardware computing system processors, cause the system to: access a decision tree comprising a plurality of nodes comprising a first node and a second node, link the first node comprised in the plurality of nodes of the decision tree with a first security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines, link the second node comprised in the plurality of nodes of the decision tree with a second security engine or the first security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines, receive a security object comprising a digital or electronic asset that is attackable using one or more attack execution operations, wherein the security object comprises at least one of: a file hash, a file registry, a

mutually exclusive flag object comprising one or more of: a mechanism serializing access to a resource, and an object managing how the resource is shared among a multiple program thread, and an indicator of compromise, and test the security object using the decision tree to determine a security parameter for the security object; wherein the security parameter is used to establish one or more remediation steps for mitigating against the one or more attack execution operations associated with the digital or electronic asset; and wherein the test the security object using the decision tree to determine the security parameter for the security object, comprises: determine, using the first security engine or the second security engine, one or more threat attribute data associated with the security object, the one or more threat attribute data comprising at least one of: a first threat attribute, a second threat attribute, a third threat attribute, and a fourth threat attribute, and determine, using the first security engine or the second security engine, the security parameter to assign to the security object.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the digital or electronic asset or the security object comprises one or more of: a file, a network internet protocol, a universal resource locator, a domain name, and a domain object.

3. The system of claim 1, further caused to: classify a malware sample associated with the security object into a threat category, or categorize the malware sample associated with the security object into a malware family based on a textual pattern or a binary pattern of the security object.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein the determine, using the first security engine or the second security engine, the security parameter to assign to the security object comprises: generate a first risk parameter using the first security engine or the second security engine, generate a second risk parameter using the second security engine, and designate one of: the first risk parameter in response to the first risk parameter being greater in magnitude than the second risk parameter, or the second risk parameter in response to the second risk parameter being greater in the magnitude than the first risk parameter.

5. The system of claim 1, wherein at least one of: the first threat attribute comprises threat actor data indicating an attacker associated with the one or more attack execution operations, the second threat attribute indicates malware data associated with the one or more attack execution operations, the third threat attribute indicates a security tool for executing the one or more attack execution operations, and the fourth threat attribute comprises user data associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations.

6. The system of claim 1, wherein the one or more threat attribute data further comprises one or more of: a fifth threat attribute comprising location data associated with the one or more attack execution operations, a sixth threat attribute comprising operating system data associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations, a seventh threat attribute comprising application package data indicative of package access information associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations, an eighth threat attribute comprising sub-operation data associated with executing at least one sub-attack execution operation associated with the one or more attack execution operations, and a ninth threat attribute comprising remediation data associated with mitigating against the one or more attack execution operations.

7. The system of claim 1, wherein at least the first node is connected to one or more second nodes comprised in the plurality of nodes, the one or more second nodes being linked with a third security engine, the third security engine being configured to execute a first security test on the security object subsequent or prior to executing a second security test using the first security engine or the second security engine.

8. The system of claim 1, wherein the test the security object using the decision tree to determine the security parameter for the security object comprises one or more of: determine a malware category to assign to the security object based on a quantitative or qualitative reputation parameter assigned to the security object, test the security object for the one or more threat attribute data, test the security object based on network threat data, test the security object based on network data, test

the security object based on threat intelligence data, test the security object based on intelligence data, test the security object based on network intelligence data, test the security object based on first vulnerability management data associated with the security object, test the security object based on second vulnerability management data, test the security object based on first policy compliance data associated with the security object, test the security object based on second policy compliance data, test the security object based on first file integrity data correlated to a first monitored security event associated with the security object, test the security object based on second file integrity data, and test the security object based on a second security event.

9. The system of claim 1, wherein the test the security object using the decision tree to determine the security parameter for the security object comprises one or more of: determine whether the security object is associated with one or more of a process object, a mutually exclusive flag object, and a network object, and determine whether the security object indicates an activity associated with a security event comprised in or associated with the one or more attack execution operations.

10. The system of claim 1, wherein the decision tree is structured based on one or more of: network threat data derived from a threat-actor behavior, the network threat data associated with a security report, and the network threat data derived from the one or more threat attribute data.

11. The system of claim 1, wherein the test the security object using the decision tree to determine the security parameter for the security object further comprises one or more of: determine, using the first the first security engine or the second security engine, whether the security object is associated with a blacklist of security objects, the blacklist of security objects comprising one or more attack objects that are denied access, and classify, using the first security engine or the second security engine, a malware sample associated with the security object.

12. A method comprising: accessing, using one or more hardware computing device processors, a decision tree comprising a plurality of nodes comprising a first node and a second node; linking, using the one or more hardware computing device processors, the first node comprised in the plurality of nodes of the decision tree with a first security engine comprised in a plurality of security engines; linking, using the one or more hardware computing device processors, the second node comprised in the plurality of nodes of the decision tree with a second security engine or the first security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines; receiving, using the one or more hardware computing device processors, a security object comprising or associated with a digital or electronic asset that is attackable using one or more attack execution operations, wherein the security object comprises at least one of: a file hash, a file registry, a mutually exclusive flag object comprising one or more of: a mechanism serializing access to a resource, and an object managing how the resource is shared among a multiple program thread, and an indicator of compromise; and testing, using the or more hardware computing device processors, the security object using the decision tree to determine a security parameter for the security object, wherein the security parameter is used to establish one or more remediation steps for mitigating against the one or more attack execution operations associated with the digital or electronic asset, and wherein the testing, using the or more hardware computing device processors, the security object using the decision tree to determine the security parameter for the security object comprises: determining, using the first security engine or the second security engine, one or more threat attribute data associated with the security object, the one or more threat attribute data comprising at least one of: a first threat attribute, a second threat attribute, a third threat attribute, and a fourth threat attribute, or determining, using the first security engine or the second security engine, the security parameter to assign to the security object.

13. The method of claim 12, wherein the digital or electronic asset or the security object comprises one or more of: a file, a network internet protocol, a universal resource locator, a domain name, and a domain object.

14. The method of claim 12, wherein at least one of: the first threat attribute comprises threat actor data indicating an attacker associated with the one or more attack execution operations, the second

threat attribute indicates malware data associated with the one or more attack execution operations, the third threat attribute indicates a security tool for executing the one or more attack execution operations, and the fourth threat attribute comprises user data associated with executing the one or more attack execution operations.

15. The method of claim 12, wherein at least the first node is connected to one or more second nodes comprised in the plurality of nodes, the one or more second nodes being linked with a third security engine, the third security engine being configured to execute a first security test on the security object subsequent or prior to executing a second security test using the first security engine or the second security engine.

16. The method of claim 12, wherein the testing, using the one or more hardware computing device processors, the security object using the decision tree to determine the security parameter for the security object comprises one or more of: determining a malware category to assign to the security object based on a quantitative or qualitative reputation parameter assigned to the security object, testing the security object for the one or more threat attribute data, testing the security object based on network threat data, testing the security object based on network data, testing the security object based on threat intelligence data, testing the security object based on intelligence data, testing the security object based on network intelligence data, testing the security object based on first vulnerability management data associated with the security object, testing the security object based on second vulnerability management data, testing the security object based on first policy compliance data associated with the security object, testing the security object based on second policy compliance data, testing the security object based on first file integrity data correlated to a first monitored security event associated with the security object, testing the security object based on second file integrity data, and testing the security object based on a second security event.

17. The method of claim 12, wherein the testing, using the one or more hardware computing device processors, the security object using the decision tree to determine the security parameter for the security object comprises one or more of: determining whether the security object is associated with one or more of: a process object, a mutually exclusive flag object, and a network object, and determining whether the security object indicates an activity associated with a security event comprised in or associated with the one or more attack execution operations.

18. The method of claim 12, wherein the testing, using the one or more hardware computing device processors, the security object using the decision tree to determine the security parameter for the security object further comprises one or more of: determining, using the first security engine or the second security engine, whether the security object is associated with a blacklist of security objects, the blacklist of security objects comprising one or more attack objects that are denied access, and classifying, using the first security engine or the second security engine, a malware sample associated with the security object.

19. A system comprising: one or more hardware computing system processors; and memory storing a plurality of security engines and instructions that, when executed by the one or more hardware computing system processors, causes the system to: access a decision tree comprising a plurality of nodes comprising a first node and a second node, link the first node comprised in the plurality of nodes of the decision tree with a first security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines, link the second node comprised in the plurality of nodes of the decision tree with a second security engine or the first security engine comprised in the plurality of security engines, receive a security object comprising a digital or electronic asset that is attackable using one or more attack execution operations, wherein the security object comprises at least one of: a file hash, a file registry, a mutually exclusive flag object comprising one or more of: a mechanism serializing access to a resource, and an object managing how the resource is shared among a multiple program thread, and an indicator of compromise, and test the security object using the decision tree to determine a security parameter for the security object; wherein the security parameter is used to establish one or more steps for mitigating against the one or more attack execution operations associated with the

digital or electronic asset; and wherein the test the security object using the decision tree to determine the security parameter for the security object, comprises: determine, using the first security engine or the second security engine, one or more threat attribute data associated with the security object, the one or more threat attribute data comprising at least one of: a first threat attribute, a second threat attribute, a third threat attribute, and a fourth threat attribute, and determine, using the first security engine or the second security engine, the security parameter to assign to the security object.

20. The system of claim 19, wherein the system is comprised in or comprises one or more computing devices.
